



Steve Harrington Earbuds

OnePlus Buds Z special edition features a dual-tone, purple and mint colour combination with funky art. <http://dgit.in/feb21-75>



EPOS GTW 270 Hybrid

Senheiser's latest gaming wireless earbuds are specifically engineered for a lag-free, low latency connection. <http://dgit.in/feb21-76>

Jabra Elite 85t

Feature-rich and fun!

Jabra has been one of the most reliable brands that offer users a dependable pair of TWS earphones every year. We finally got our hands on the Jabra Elite 85t, the company's newest TWS offering. Let's see if the earphones are as competent in real life as they seem to be on paper.

Build and comfort

Jabra describes the Elite 85t as "semi-open" earphones that don't need to be jammed all the way in your ear canals to achieve a proper fit. The buds are still pretty tiny but not quite as diminutive as the 75t, which feels like a step back in some ways. The same goes for the charging case, which also has a considerably larger footprint than its predecessor's charging case.

The buds also come equipped with IPX4 water and sweat resistance, down from the IP55 water and dust resistant rating on the Jabra Elite 75t.

The earbuds slid into our ears easily and stayed put through normal movement and light exercise. Due to the new oval shape of the eartips, it is integral to find the right fit since the earphones slip out of the ears if the wearer is using wrong-sized ear tips.

App and other features

The Jabra Sound+ app is one of the most comprehensive accompanying apps for TWS earphones. It comes equipped with a 5-band customisable EQ that can be used to tweak sound settings. You can also customise the controls of your earbuds via the Jabra Sound+ app.

App aside, the earphones, powered by Bluetooth v5.1 and come with multipoint connection support. You can also use the buds in Mono mode, however, only the right earbud can be



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used independently, which is a bit odd. There's also support for the SBC and AAC audio codecs, however, Android users will be disappointed to know that the buds don't support the high quality aptX

codec. Finally, you also get Qi wireless charging support for the case.

Active Noise Cancellation and HearThrough performance

The headlining feature of the Jabra Elite 85t is Active Noise Cancellation. The ANC on the Jabra Elite 85t is excellent. The earphones are definitely catching up to the heavyweights in this category – the Sony WF-1000XM3 and the Bose QuietComfort Earbuds. The earphones displayed excellent performance in cancelling out low and mid-range ambient sounds. It even muffled a fair bit of some human voices.

HearThrough is also pretty good on the Jabra Elite 85t. The environmental sounds are clearly audible and, thankfully, they don't sound unnatural.

Sound quality

Equipped with 12mm drivers, the Jabra Elite 85t establishes itself as a reasonably balanced sounding pair of earphones. The bass notes are slightly exaggerated, however, they are far tamer than what was seen on their predecessors, the Jabra Elite 75t. If you're looking for some punch and oomph in

the bass regions from your earphones, these earphones provide you that without sounding muddy or jarring.

The mids are excellent on the Jabra Elite 85t leading to some of the best vocal performances we've seen reproduced on true wireless earphones.

The highs are decent, at best. The dip in the frequency graph at 3K suggests that highs aren't rendered with the best detail. Moving on to the soundstage, due to the semi open design the music does sound slightly more open and natural than the Elite 75t.

Battery life

The Jabra Elite 85t comes with 5.5 hours of battery life on the buds with ANC turned on (7 hours with ANC off), as per the company. The total battery life along with the charging case is rated at 25 hours with ANC turned on and 31 hours with ANC turned off.

In our tests, we found that the earbuds lasted for about 5 hours and 45 minutes with ANC turned on at about 60 percent volume. The case charges back up to full from zero percent in about 3 hours via a USB-C cable.

Verdict

The Jabra Elite 85t are the company's best true wireless earbuds yet. The addition of competent ANC, as well as the refinement of the sound quality has definitely earned Jabra a place in the spotlight. The earphones are slowly but surely catching up to the leaders in the premium segment including Sony, Apple, and Bose.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

SPEAKER SIZE: 12 mm | SPEAKER BANDWIDTH (MUSIC PLAYBACK): 20Hz to 20kHz | SPEAKER BANDWIDTH (CALLS): 100Hz to 10kHz | MICROPHONE TYPE: 6 x MEMS | AUDIO CODECS SUPPORTED: SBC, AAC | ANC: Yes, adjustable | HEARTHROUGH: Yes, adjustable | MUSIC TIME WITH ANC: Up to 25 hours total (Earbud 5.5 hrs and charging case 19.5 hrs) | MUSIC TIME WITHOUT ANC: Up to 31 hours total (Earbud 7 hrs and charging case 24 hrs) | WIRELESS CHARGING ENABLED: Yes | CHARGING TIME: Up to 3 hours for full charge with dedicated USB wall charger (500mA) | CONNECTIVITY: Bluetooth 5.1 | OPERATING RANGE: Up to 10 m / 33 ft

CONTACT

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